KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 6: VOICES OF CHANGE · WEEK 26 · READING

# Gold Above the Rink — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

**Learning objectives:** Students explain what a myth is and how it differs from an allusion, identify allusions to myths from ancient Greece and Rome and from Hawai‘i, crack an allusion in four steps (spot the name, recall the myth, find the key feature, apply it), connect each allusion in a story to the myth behind it, retell a myth accurately while noticing that myths change as they are retold, and compare how a story and an informational text use the same myths.

**Duration:** 35–45 minutes
**Materials:** Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

## Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: at Rockefeller Center in New York City, a gilded bronze statue of Prometheus by the sculptor Paul Manship (1934) flies above the winter ice rink. Meera skates there with her cousin Maddox and Aunt Maren, who sprinkle their talk with phrases from ancient myths, and then the student reads myth cards from ancient Greece and Rome and from Hawai‘i. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Unit 5 Review (8 pts, 4 each): inference, character traits versus feelings, character change and theme (Week 24 and the Week 25 Checkpoint).
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W26.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: Myths and Allusions. A myth is the whole traditional story; an allusion is a quick mention of it that readers are expected to recognize. Model story “The Messy Room”: Melvin calls cleaning his room “a Herculean job.” Four steps: spot the name, recall the story (the twelve labors), find the key feature (huge tasks), apply it (a huge, exhausting job).
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 8 flip cards (myth, allusion, origin, mortals, consequence, retelling, gilded, wobbled).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: Gold Above the Rink (5 pts). An original realistic story in six paragraphs, quoting the real inscription behind the statue. Aunt Maren explains Prometheus; Meera says Maddox “has the Midas touch”; left turns are her “Achilles’ heel”; Aunt Maren calls Maddox “Echo” when he repeats her; and when Meera wants to come back every Saturday, Maddox says he “just opened Pandora’s box.” Use the paragraph numbers.
8. Slide 7 — Text B: Six Myth Cards (5 pts). Prometheus; Pandora (Hesiod’s jar became a “box” when Erasmus wrote about it in 1508, and hope stayed inside); King Midas (his food turned to gold; he washed in the river Pactolus; Nathaniel Hawthorne added the golden daughter in the 1800s); Echo and Narcissus (Ovid); Achilles (the Iliad never mentions the heel; the River Styx comes from later tellings); and the Hawaiian mo‘olelo of Māui snaring the sun from Haleakalā.

9. Slide 8 — Tracking the Allusions (10 pts, 5 each): connect each allusion in Text A to its myth card, find the key feature, and infer what the character means.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Retell It Right. The four steps again; myths change when they are retold, so an accurate retelling says which version it follows (Pandora's jar, Midas's daughter, Achilles' heel). Compare the weak (literal) and strong explanations of "Pandora's box."
11. Slide 10 — Allusion Detective (12 pts, 6 each): use an allusion correctly, check what the cards support, and catch mistakes in myth retellings.
12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. A compound sentence needs a comma before but or and, and an introductory word or phrase is followed by a comma.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the card or story sentence named in the item, starting with the tag shown, a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Retell and Explain (6 pts): one typed retelling or explanation auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): allusions matched to their meanings, myth figures matched to what they did, or story words matched to meanings (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick myth and allusion questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across the story and the cards (name the myth or allusion, then check the meaning, the theme, the evidence or the card).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W26.pdf), including the ★ Challenge writing task if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Allusion Ace!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Myth Master!" with the congratulations message "Myth master! You cracked every allusion!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

## Lesson answer key with reasoning

*Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.*

### WARM-UP: UNIT 5 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| `rv1_s0` | Set 1: Read: "Mena crossed her arms and stared out the window when her mom said the family was moving to a new city." Which inference is BEST supported? [Mena is upset about moving. / Mena is excited about moving. / Mena is cold and wants a sweater. / Mena is looking for a bird outside.] | **Mena is upset about moving.** | Crossed arms and staring away from her mom are clues; we know people often act this way when they are upset. Nothing in the text supports the other choices (Week 24). |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| rv2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: a word that tells how a character USUALLY is, such as stubborn or generous, names a character ___. | **trait** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | A character trait tells how a character usually is. A feeling, like bored or surprised, can pass quickly (Week 24). |
| rv1_s1 | Set 2: Which word is a character TRAIT, not a feeling that passes quickly? [Patient / Sleepy / Surprised / Hungry] | **Patient** | Sleepy, surprised, and hungry are feelings that come and go. Patient describes how someone usually acts, so it is a trait (Week 24). |
| rv2_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: a smart conclusion built from text clues plus what you already know is called an ___. | **inference** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | Text clues plus what you know make an inference (Week 24). |
| rv1_s2 | Set 3: At the start of a story, Malcolm never shares his colored pencils. Which event near the END would BEST show that he has changed? [He hands his best pencils to a new classmate without being asked. / He sharpens his pencils before class. / He puts his pencils back in their box. / He tells his friend that his pencils are new.] | **He hands his best pencils to a new classmate without being asked.** | A change in a trait (selfish to generous) must be shown with an action. Only sharing without being asked shows the new trait (Week 24). |
| rv2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: the message about life that a story teaches, often through how a character changes, is the ___. | **theme** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | The theme is the lesson about life a story shows, often through character change (Week 24). |

## YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| v1_s0 | Set 1: From the story: “a huge gilded statue of a man seemed to fly through a ring marked with the signs of the zodiac.” The statue shines like gold. Using the context, what does gilded most likely mean? [Covered with a thin layer of gold / Carved out of ice / Painted bright red / Broken into pieces] | **Covered with a thin layer of gold** | The statue shines like gold, so gilded means covered with a thin layer of gold. |
| v2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: a quick reference to a well-known story, person, or event that the writer expects you to recognize, without explaining it, is an ___. | **allusion** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | A reference readers are expected to recognize is an allusion. (Be careful: an illusion is something that tricks your eyes.) |
| v1_s1 | Set 2: From the story: “when she stepped onto the ice at Rockefeller Center in New York City, her knees wobbled anyway.” Meera is nervous on the ice. What does wobbled most likely mean? [Shook unsteadily from side to side / Stood perfectly still / Grew stronger and faster / Bent into a bow] | **Shook unsteadily from side to side** | A nervous skater on slippery ice has shaky knees, so wobbled means shook unsteadily. |
| v2_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: a traditional story, often about gods or heroes, that explains something about the world, such as how people got fire, is a ___. | **myth** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | A traditional story that explains the world or teaches a lesson, often with gods or heroes, is a myth. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| v1_s2 | Set 3: From the words carved behind the statue: “brought the fire that hath proved to mortals a means to mighty ends.” In Greek myths, the gods live forever. Using that clue, who are mortals? [Humans, who do not live forever / Gods who live on a mountain / Statues made of gold / Skaters who never fall] | **Humans, who do not live forever** | Mortals are set apart from the gods, who live forever, so mortals are humans. |
| v2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: the place or story that a word or phrase comes from is its ___. | **origin** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural) | Where something comes from is its origin. The origin of “Herculean” is the myth of Hercules. |

## TEXT A: THE STORY (5 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| sa_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 2, Aunt Maren says that in the Greek myth, Prometheus stole ___ from the gods and gave it to people. | **fire** | Paragraph 2 says, “he stole fire from the gods and gave it to people.” |
| sa_s1 | Set 2: In paragraph 3, Meera says Maddox “has the Midas touch. Everything he tries turns to gold.” What does she mean? [Everything Maddox tries seems to succeed easily. / Everything Maddox touches really turns into gold metal. / Maddox is a king who rules a faraway land. / Maddox is bad at skating and keeps falling.] | **Everything Maddox tries seems to succeed easily.** | This is an allusion, not a literal statement. Meera means Maddox succeeds at everything he tries, the way everything Midas touched became gold. |
| sa_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: in paragraph 4, Meera uses an allusion to describe her trouble with left turns. Type the name of the Greek hero in that allusion. | **achilles** | Paragraph 4 says, “Left turns are my Achilles’ heel.” Achilles is the Greek warrior from Card 5. |

## TEXT B: THE MYTH CARDS (5 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| sb_s0 | Set 1: According to Card 2, what was Pandora’s container in the oldest telling, by the Greek poet Hesiod? [A large jar / A wooden box / A golden chest / A leather bag] | **A large jar** | Card 2 says, “In the oldest telling, by the Greek poet Hesiod about 2,700 years ago, the container was a jar.” Erasmus called it a box in 1508. |
| sb_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: according to Card 3, Dionysus told Midas to wash in the river ___ to undo his wish. | **pactolus** | Card 3 says, “the god told him to wash in the river Pactolus.” |
| sb_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: according to Card 6, what did Māui braid his strong rope from? | **coconut** | Card 6 says, “Māui braided a strong rope from coconut fiber.” |

## TRACKING THE ALLUSIONS (5 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| qp1_s0 | Set 1: In paragraph 5, Aunt Maren calls Maddox "Echo." Using Card 4, why does this allusion fit? [Like the nymph Echo, Maddox keeps repeating the last words someone else says. / Like Echo, Maddox is shouting inside a cave. / Like Narcissus, Maddox fell in love with his reflection. / Like Prometheus, Maddox stole fire.] | **Like the nymph Echo, Maddox keeps repeating the last words someone else says.** | Juno made Echo repeat only the last words she heard. Maddox squeaks "Bend your knees!" and "Want to go!", repeating Aunt Maren. |
| qp2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. Card 4 says a flower grew where Narcissus wasted away and that it still carries his name. Type the name of that flower. | **narcissus** (also accepted: narcissi; with "a" or "an" or in the plural) | Card 4 says the flower "still carries his name," so it is the narcissus, a spring flower. |
| qp1_s1 | Set 2: At the end, Maddox says, "I think I just opened Pandora's box." Using Card 2, what does he mean? [By helping Meera, he started something that will bring more trouble than he expected, like skating every Saturday. / He found a real box hidden under the rink. / He gave Meera a present wrapped in a box. / He is the first man ever created by the gods.] | **By helping Meera, he started something that will bring more trouble than he expected, like skating every Saturday.** | Card 2 says opening "Pandora's box" means starting something that leads to many problems no one expected. Meera now wants to come back every Saturday. |
| qp2_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: two steps. Aunt Maren warns, "Things did not turn out so well for Midas." Using Card 3, what turned to gold the moment it touched Midas's lips? Type one word. | **food** (also accepted: bread, meal; with "a" or "an" or in the plural) | Card 3 says "his food turned to gold the moment it touched his lips," so his wish became a problem. |
| qp1_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Mercedes says, "When Meera says Maddox has the Midas touch, she means he turns things into real gold." Which explanation is correct? [Mercedes reads the allusion literally. Meera means Maddox succeeds at everything, the way everything Midas touched became gold. / Mercedes is right. Maddox turns his skates into gold. / Mercedes is wrong because the allusion is about Pandora. / Mercedes is wrong because Midas never touched anything.] | **Mercedes reads the allusion literally. Meera means Maddox succeeds at everything, the way everything Midas touched became gold.** | An allusion borrows a key feature of a myth. It is not a literal statement. Nothing in the story turns into real gold. |
| qp2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Card 5 says Achilles was dipped in a river to protect him, and the heel his mother held stayed unprotected. Type the name of that river. | **styx** | Card 5 says Thetis "dipped baby Achilles in the River Styx to protect him, holding him by one heel." |

## ALLUSION DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| d1_s0 | Set 1: Which sentence uses an allusion to Achilles CORRECTLY? [Our team is strong, but our slow defense is our Achilles' heel. / My Achilles' heel is the thing I do best of all. / I wore my Achilles' heel shoes to the rink. / She has an Achilles' heel, so everything she touches turns to gold.] | **Our team is strong, but our slow defense is our Achilles' heel.** | An Achilles' heel is one weak spot in someone or something strong. Only the team sentence names a weak spot in a strong team. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| d2_s0 | Set 1: Which statement about what a myth explains is supported by the cards? [The moʻolelo of Māui explains why the days became longer. / The myth of Achilles explains why it snows in winter. / The myth of Midas explains how rainbows form. / The myth of Pandora explains why the ocean is salty.] | **The moʻolelo of Māui explains why the days became longer.** | Card 6 says that after Māui snared the sun, “The sun promised to travel slowly, and the days grew longer.” No card makes the other claims. |
| d1_s1 | Set 2: Which explanation of the difference between a myth and an allusion is correct? [A myth is a whole traditional story; an allusion is a quick mention of a well-known story that readers are expected to recognize. / A myth and an allusion are exactly the same thing. / An allusion is a long story, and a myth is a single word. / An allusion is a trick that fools your eyes, like a magic show.] | **A myth is a whole traditional story; an allusion is a quick mention of a well-known story that readers are expected to recognize.** | The myth is the full story. The allusion is a short reference to it, like “the Midas touch.” A trick that fools your eyes is an illusion. |
| d2_s1 | Set 2: Find the mistake! Melvin retells: “Pandora opened a box, and every single thing inside flew out, even hope.” Which correction is accurate? [In the oldest telling it was a jar, not a box, and hope stayed inside. / Melvin is right; nothing needs to change. / It was a box, but only hope flew out. / Pandora never opened anything; Prometheus did.] | **In the oldest telling it was a jar, not a box, and hope stayed inside.** | Card 2: Hesiod’s container was a jar (Erasmus called it a box in 1508), and “Only hope stayed inside.” |
| d1_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Mena writes, “The ancient Roman poet Ovid tells how King Midas turned his daughter into gold.” What is wrong? [The golden daughter was added in the 1800s by Nathaniel Hawthorne; in the ancient telling, Midas’s food turns to gold. / Nothing is wrong. Ovid tells about the daughter. / Midas was not a king; he was a river. / Ovid was a Greek poet who lived in the 1800s.] | **The golden daughter was added in the 1800s by Nathaniel Hawthorne; in the ancient telling, Midas’s food turns to gold.** | Card 3 says Hawthorne added the daughter in the 1800s, “but she is not in the ancient Roman poet Ovid’s telling.” In Ovid, his food turns to gold. |
| d2_s2 | Set 3: Which situation could BEST be described as “opening Pandora’s box”? [A boy repeats one silly rumor, and soon it causes arguments that he cannot stop. / A girl finds a box of old photos in the attic. / A coach wins every game she plays. / A runner has one weak ankle.] | **A boy repeats one silly rumor, and soon it causes arguments that he cannot stop.** | Opening Pandora’s box means starting something that leads to many unexpected problems. The photo box is literal, the coach fits the Midas touch, and the ankle is an Achilles’ heel. |

## FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| fs1_s0 | Set 1: Title punctuation: put quotation marks around the story’s title. In the story Gold Above the Rink, Meera learns to turn left. | **In the story "Gold Above the Rink," Meera learns to turn left.** | The title of a story goes inside quotation marks, and the comma after the title goes inside the closing quotation mark. |
| fs2_s0 | Set 1: Dialogue punctuation: add the missing comma. "Left turns are my weak spot" Meera groaned. | **"Left turns are my weak spot," Meera groaned.** | When the speaker tag comes after the spoken words, a comma goes inside the closing quotation mark. |
| fs3_s0 | Set 1: Compound sentence: add the comma before the joining word “but.” Midas loved gold but he could not eat it. | **Midas loved gold, but he could not eat it.** | When “but” joins two complete sentences, put a comma before it. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| fs4_s0 | Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. Meera and Maddox skates every Saturday. | **Meera and Maddox skate every Saturday.** | “Meera and Maddox” is a compound subject (two people), so it needs the plural verb “skate,” not “skates.” |
| fs1_s1 | Set 2: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three myth figures. The cards retell myths about Midas Echo and Achilles. | **The cards retell myths about Midas, Echo, and Achilles.** (also accepted: The cards retell myths about Midas, Echo and Achilles.) | Use commas to separate three items in a series: Midas, Echo, and Achilles. |
| fs2_s1 | Set 2: Capital letters: fix the five capital-letter mistakes in the place names. Meera skated at rockefeller center in new york city. | **Meera skated at Rockefeller Center in New York City.** | The names of specific places are proper nouns, so each important word is capitalized: Rockefeller Center, New York City. |
| fs3_s1 | Set 2: Comma after an introductory phrase: add the missing comma. At the end of the rink a golden statue rises above the ice. | **At the end of the rink, a golden statue rises above the ice.** | Put a comma after an introductory phrase like “At the end of the rink.” |
| fs4_s1 | Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it’s mistake. The sun slowed it's journey across the sky. | **The sun slowed its journey across the sky.** | “It’s” means “it is.” The journey belongs to the sun, so use the possessive “its” with no apostrophe. |
| fs1_s2 | Set 3: Dialogue punctuation: move the question mark to the right spot. "Can we come back next Saturday"? Meera asked. | **"Can we come back next Saturday?" Meera asked.** | The question mark belongs to the words Meera asked, so it goes inside the closing quotation mark. |
| fs2_s2 | Set 3: Dialogue capitalization: fix the capital-letter mistake. Maddox said, "everybody has one weak spot." | **Maddox said, "Everybody has one weak spot."** | The first word of a quoted sentence is capitalized, even in the middle of your sentence. |
| fs3_s2 | Set 3: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Later Narcissus saw his reflection in a pool. | **Later, Narcissus saw his reflection in a pool.** | Put a comma after an introductory word like “Later.” |
| fs4_s2 | Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they’re mistake. The skaters laced up there skates by the rail. | **The skaters laced up their skates by the rail.** | The skates belong to the skaters, so use the possessive “their,” not “there.” |

## BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| qt_s0 | Set 1: This sentence explains how Pandora’s jar became a “box.” Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text B, Card 2): In 1508, a Dutch scholar named Erasmus called it a box, and that word stuck. Start with: The author writes | **The author writes, "In 1508, a Dutch scholar named Erasmus called it a box, and that word stuck."** | Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word, the number, and both commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside. |
| qt_s1 | Set 2: This sentence shows that one famous detail of the Midas story was added later. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text B, Card 3): In the 1800s, the American writer Nathaniel Hawthorne added a daughter who turns to gold, but she is not in the ancient Roman poet Ovid’s telling. Start with: The author writes | **The author writes, "In the 1800s, the American writer Nathaniel Hawthorne added a daughter who turns to gold, but she is not in the ancient Roman poet Ovid's telling."** | Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word, both commas, and the apostrophe in “Ovid’s” inside quotation marks, with the period inside. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| qt_s2 | Set 3: This sentence describes the statue Meera sees. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 1): At the far end of the rink, against a granite wall, a huge gilded statue of a man seemed to fly through a ring marked with the signs of the zodiac. Start with: The author writes | **The author writes, "At the far end of the rink, against a granite wall, a huge gilded statue of a man seemed to fly through a ring marked with the signs of the zodiac."** | Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and both commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside. |

## WRITER'S TURN: RETELL AND EXPLAIN (6 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| wt_s0 | Set 1: In one or two sentences, RETELL the myth of King Midas accurately: his wish, the problem it caused, and how it ended. Text B, Card 3: King Midas ruled Phrygia, a land in what is now Turkey. When Midas helped Silenus, a companion of Dionysus, the god of wine, Dionysus offered him any wish. Midas wished that everything he touched would turn to gold. At first he was thrilled, but then his food turned to gold the moment it touched his lips. He begged Dionysus to take the wish back, and the god told him to wash in the river Pactolus. Midas was cured, and the river's sand sparkled with gold. In the 1800s, the American writer Nathaniel Hawthorne added a daughter who turns to gold, but she is not in the ancient Roman poet Ovid's telling. Today, someone with "the Midas touch" seems to make everything succeed. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the card. (Names like King Midas and Pactolus are fine.) Name the character: include Midas or the king. Tell the wish: everything he touched would become gold. Tell the problem: his food turned to gold, so he could not eat. Tell the ending: he washed in the river (the Pactolus) and was cured. Original: "King Midas ruled Phrygia, a land in what is now Turkey. When Midas helped Silenus, a companion of Dionysus, the god of wine, Dionysus offered him any wish. Midas wished that everything he touched would turn to gold. At first he was ..." (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here) | **Sample:** Dionysus granted Midas a wish, so everything the king touched became gold, but when even his meals turned to metal, he bathed in the Pactolus to break the spell. | A strong retelling names Midas, his wish for a golden touch, the problem with his food, and the cure in the river Pactolus, all in new words. It leaves out the daughter, who is not in the ancient telling. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: midas or king; wish or touch or gold; food or eat or meal or bread or hungry or starv or lunch or dinner or drink; river or pactolus or wash or bath or cure or undo or took back or take back or water or swim. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| wt_s1 | Set 2: In one or two sentences, explain what Meera means when she says, “Left turns are my Achilles’ heel,” AND tell the myth behind the phrase. Text A, paragraph 4, and Text B, Card 5: “Left turns are my Achilles’ heel,” she groaned. … Achilles was the greatest Greek warrior in the war against Troy. Homer’s ancient poem the Iliad tells of his anger, but it never mentions a weak heel. That detail comes from later tellings: his mother, the sea nymph Thetis, dipped baby Achilles in the River Styx to protect him, holding him by one heel, so that spot stayed unprotected. In the end, Paris of Troy shot an arrow, guided by the god Apollo, that struck Achilles in the heel, and the wound ended his life. Today, an “Achilles’ heel” is one weak spot in someone or something strong. The Achilles tendon, just above your heel, is named after him. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the story or the card. (Names like Achilles and Thetis are fine.) Name who or what: include Meera or her left turns. Give the meaning: left turns are her one weak spot or hardest skill. Name the myth: include Achilles, the Greek warrior or hero. Tell the myth detail: the heel his mother held when she dipped him, or the arrow. Original: “Meera pushed off again, but on her first left turn, her skates slid out from under her, and she landed with a thump. Left turns are my Achilles' heel, she groaned. Maddox skidded over and held out a hand. Everybody has one weak spot, he …” (the full passage is on screen; it is long, so only its opening is shown here) | **Sample:** Meera means that turning left is the one skill she struggles with, just like Achilles, the mighty warrior whose only unprotected spot was the heel his mother held. | A strong answer gives the meaning (left turns are Meera’s one weak spot) and the myth (Thetis held Achilles by the heel when she dipped him, so that spot was unprotected), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: meera or she or turn or left; weak or trouble or hard or struggle or problem or bad at or difficult or only; achilles or warrior or hero or greek or myth; heel or dip or river or styx or arrow or mother or unprotected or held or hold. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| wt_s2 | Set 3: In one or two sentences, RETELL the Hawaiian moʻolelo of Māui and the sun accurately: the problem, what Māui did, and how it ended. Text B, Card 6: In a Hawaiian moʻolelo (story), the sun once raced across the sky so fast that Māui's mother, Hina, could not dry her kapa, a cloth made from bark. Māui braided a strong rope from coconut fiber, carried it to the top of Haleakalā, and snared the sun's rays. The sun promised to travel slowly, and the days grew longer. Haleakalā, a volcano on the island of Maui, is often translated as "house of the sun." Today, visitors still travel to the top of Haleakalā to watch the sunrise. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the card. (Names like Maui, Hina, and Haleakala are fine.) Name the hero: include Maui (or he). Tell the problem: the sun moved too fast, so the cloth could not dry. Tell the action: he caught the sun with a rope. Tell the ending: the sun moved slowly and the days grew longer. Original: "In a Hawaiian moolelo (story), the sun once raced across the sky so fast that Maui's mother, Hina, could not dry her kapa, a cloth made from bark. Maui braided a strong rope from coconut fiber, carried it to the top of Haleakala, and snared the sun's rays. The sun promised to travel slowly, and the days grew longer. Haleakala, a volcano on the island of Maui, is often translated as house of the sun. Today, visitors still travel to the top of Haleakala to watch the sunrise." | **Sample:** Because the sun hurried across the sky and Hina was unable to dry her bark cloth, Maui used a coconut rope to catch its rays until it agreed to move slower. | A strong retelling tells the problem (the sun moved too fast for Hina's kapa to dry), the action (Māui snared the sun with a coconut-fiber rope on Haleakalā), and the ending (the sun slowed and days grew longer), in new words. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: maui; fast or quick or speed or rac or hurr or short or rush or wet or dry; rope or snare or lasso or caught or catch or trap or tie or tied or grab or lass; slow or longer or long. |

## MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| match_s0_1 | Set 1: Match Pandora's box | **a source of many unexpected troubles** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_2 | Set 1: Match the Midas touch | **the knack of making everything succeed** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_3 | Set 1: Match an Achilles' heel | **one weak spot in someone strong** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_4 | Set 1: Match an echo | **a sound that bounces back** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_5 | Set 1: Match myth | **a traditional story about gods or heroes** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_1 | Set 2: Match Prometheus | **took fire from the gods for humans** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_2 | Set 2: Match Pandora | **lifted the lid of a jar of troubles** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| match_s1_3 | Set 2: Match Midas | **wished for a golden touch** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_4 | Set 2: Match Narcissus | **fell in love with his reflection** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_5 | Set 2: Match Māui | **snared the sun from Haleakalā** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_1 | Set 3: Match gilded | **covered with a thin layer of gold** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_2 | Set 3: Match wobbled | **shook unsteadily** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_3 | Set 3: Match mortals | **humans, who do not live forever** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_4 | Set 3: Match allusion | **a reference readers should recognize** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_5 | Set 3: Match origin | **where something comes from** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |

## BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| b1_s0 | Set 1: Two-step: “When the new coach arrived, every player she trained started winning. She had the Midas touch.” Step 1, name the myth. Step 2, give the meaning. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Myth: King Midas. Meaning: everything she works on succeeds. / Myth: King Midas. Meaning: she turns her players into gold statues. / Myth: Pandora. Meaning: she causes trouble everywhere. / Myth: Achilles. Meaning: she has one weak spot.] | **Myth: King Midas. Meaning: everything she works on succeeds.** | The phrase points to Midas, whose touch turned things to gold. As an allusion it means everything the coach works on succeeds, not that anyone becomes gold. |
| b2_s0 | Set 1: Two-step: Step 1, choose a theme of the Midas myth. Step 2, choose evidence for it from Card 3. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Theme: Getting everything you wish for can bring problems you did not expect. Evidence: “his food turned to gold the moment it touched his lips.” / Theme: Getting everything you wish for can bring problems you did not expect. Evidence: “King Midas ruled Phrygia, a land in what is now Turkey.” / Theme: Gold is the most valuable thing in the world. Evidence: “his food turned to gold the moment it touched his lips.” / Theme: Always help strangers. Evidence: “the river’s sand sparkled with gold.”] | **Theme: Getting everything you wish for can bring problems you did not expect. Evidence: “his food turned to gold the moment it touched his lips.”** | Midas’s wish ruins his meals, so the food line proves the theme. Where Phrygia is does not support any theme, and the myth teaches the opposite of “gold is most valuable.” |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| b1_s1 | Set 2: Which explanation of how Text A and Text B use myths DIFFERENTLY is correct? [Text A, a story, has characters use allusions in everyday talk without explaining them; Text B, an informational text, retells the myths and tells where the phrases came from. / Both texts retell every myth in full detail. / Text A explains where each phrase comes from, and Text B uses allusions without explaining them. / Neither text mentions any myths.] | **Text A, a story, has characters use allusions in everyday talk without explaining them; Text B, an informational text, retells the myths and tells where the phrases came from.** | In Text A, Meera says "Achilles' heel" and nobody explains it. Text B's cards retell the myths and give each phrase's origin, including how the myths changed over time. |
| b2_s1 | Set 2: Two-step: Maddox is great at spinning, but he cannot stop without spinning. Step 1, which allusion fits his stopping problem? Step 2, which card explains it? [Allusion: his Achilles' heel. Card: Card 5. / Allusion: his Achilles' heel. Card: Card 3. / Allusion: the Midas touch. Card: Card 3. / Allusion: Pandora's box. Card: Card 2.] | **Allusion: his Achilles' heel. Card: Card 5.** | One weak spot in someone strong is an Achilles' heel, and Card 5 tells the myth of Achilles. Card 3 is about Midas. |
| b1_s2 | Set 3: Which NEW situation fits the allusion "Echo" the way Aunt Maren uses it in paragraph 5? [A little brother repeats the last few words of everything his sister says. / A girl stares at her reflection in a store window. / A man takes something that belongs to the gods. / A runner has one weak ankle.] | **A little brother repeats the last few words of everything his sister says.** | Aunt Maren calls Maddox "Echo" because he repeats her last words, just as Juno made Echo repeat only the last words she heard. The other choices fit Narcissus, Prometheus, and Achilles. |
| b2_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Mehdi says, "The story of Māui and the sun is a Greek myth, and it explains how people got fire." Which explanation is correct? [It is a Hawaiian moʻolelo, and it explains why the days grew longer; the Greek myth about fire is the story of Prometheus. / Mehdi is right on both points. / It is a Greek myth, but it explains why hope stayed in the jar. / It is a Roman poem by Ovid about a river of gold.] | **It is a Hawaiian moʻolelo, and it explains why the days grew longer; the Greek myth about fire is the story of Prometheus.** | Card 6 calls it a Hawaiian moʻolelo in which the sun slows and the days grow longer. Card 1 tells how Prometheus brought fire to humans. |

## Pre & Post sheet answer guide

*Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W26.pdf.*

### PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Review: "Meera gripped the rail with both hands and would not let go." | Model: Meera is nervous or afraid of falling. Clue: she grips the rail with both hands and will not let go. |
| 2 | A myth, legend or hero story you know, and one event | Answers vary. Check for a named story and one thing that happens in it. |
| 3 | "Carrying everyone's skates up the subway stairs was a Herculean job." | Carrying the skates was a huge, exhausting job, like the nearly impossible tasks of Hercules. |
| 4 | Which phrase means "one weak spot in someone strong"? | An Achilles' heel |

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 5 | A question about nature that a myth might answer | Answers vary (for example, “Why does the sun cross the sky?”, “Where did fire come from?”, or “Why do we hear echoes?”). Check that it is a question about nature. |

## POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Maddox: “This trip has turned into Pandora’s box.” | Model: Maddox means one problem led to many more troubles he did not expect (the spilled cocoa, the cold, the lost gloves). In the Greek myth, Pandora lifted the lid of a jar, and troubles flew out into the world; only hope stayed inside. |
| 2 | Aunt Maren is a great skater but is afraid of skating backward | An Achilles’ heel. Model: Skating backward is Aunt Maren’s Achilles’ heel. |
| 3 | Mehdi: “Narcissus could only repeat the last words he heard, so Juno turned him into a flower.” | Model: Juno punished the nymph Echo, so she could repeat only the last words she heard. Narcissus fell in love with his own reflection in a pool and wasted away, and a flower that carries his name grew in his place. |
| 4 | Be the editor | a) Later, Midas washed in the river. b) Meera asked, "Can we skate at Rockefeller Center again?" |

## ★ CHALLENGE

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Retell the moʻolelo of Māui and the sun; how is it like the Prometheus myth? | Model: The sun raced across the sky so fast that Hina could not dry her kapa. Māui braided a strong rope from coconut fiber, climbed Haleakalā, and snared the sun’s rays. The sun promised to travel slowly, so the days grew longer. Like Prometheus, Māui takes on a powerful force to help people, and both myths explain something about the world (longer days, and how people got fire). |